



Guide for Referring Physicians

Fixation protocols, requirements by study type, turnaround times, and coordination with our anatomic pathology laboratory.

Dr. Susana Vighi Pathology Center
Concepción Arenal 3732, Buenos Aires · Argentina
www.susanavighi.com.ar

REFERRAL WORKFLOW

From collection to report

Four steps, designed to minimize delays and ensure full traceability of every sample received.

01 Request

Fill out the form with patient data, presumptive diagnosis, prior studies, and the referring physician's details.

02 Sample fixation

10% buffered formalin at a 10:1 ratio to tissue volume. Container labeled with the patient's name and ID number.

03 Shipping or pickup

Free pickup within Buenos Aires City and Greater Buenos Aires, coordinated by phone. We also receive shipments from anywhere in the country.

04 Receipt and traceability

Each sample receives a unique tracking code, and a receipt confirmation is sent to the referring physician.

IMPORTANT — For any questions about fixation, transport, or turnaround times, contact our medical coordination team before sending the sample.

REQUIREMENTS BY STUDY TYPE

Sample preparation

Needle / endoscopic biopsy

- 10% buffered formalin
- Labeled with name and ID number
- Request form with precise anatomical location
- Attach endoscopy report if applicable

Surgical specimen

- Immediate fixation in 10% formalin (10:1 ratio)
- Do not section before shipping unless instructed
- Request form with complete clinical and surgical data
- Arrange pickup within 24 hours

Gynecologic cytology (Pap smear)

- Smear on a labeled slide
- Fixed with cytology spray or 96° alcohol
- Clinical data: LMP, hormone therapy, relevant history

Fine-needle aspiration (FNA)

- Air-dried smears (Diff-Quick) and fixed smears (Papanicolaou)
- Material in liquid medium for cell block if applicable
- Request form with location, size, and ultrasound findings

Intraoperative (frozen section) biopsy

- Coordinate in advance by phone
- Fresh, unfixed sample in a sterile container
- Immediate transport to the laboratory

Molecular studies / complex IHC

- Sample fixed in 10% formalin (minimum 6 h, maximum 48 h)
- Paraffin block with representative material
- Request form specifying required markers

AVERAGE TURNAROUND TIME

Business days from receipt

Study	Estimated time
Pap smear	3 business days
Biopsy	6 business days
Immunohistochemistry	7 business days
Biopsy with IHC	9 business days

More complex studies (molecular biology, special techniques) may require additional time. Intraoperative (frozen section) biopsies are reported during the surgical procedure.

MEDICAL COORDINATION

Let's talk directly

Phone lines	(5411) 4551-7752 · (5411) 4551-7267 · (5411) 2035-9667
Referral coordination	anatomia.patologica@susanavighi.com.ar
Service requests	solicituddeservicio@susanavighi.com.ar
Address	Concepción Arenal 3732, Buenos Aires, C1427EKH, Argentina
Business hours	Monday to Friday, 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM

This guide summarizes the information published at susanavighi.com.ar/derivantes. In the event of protocol changes, the version on the website takes precedence over printed copies.